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SMART BUYS, SMARTER TEAMS

Kashvee Gautam and Vrinda Dinesh stole the limelight with **impressive bids** in an auction that saw a shift in focus from star value to strategic team-building.

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There has been a shift in dynamics of player auctions over the years. Instead of solely focusing on star value, teams have started looking to fill the gaps, making smart buys with limited resources at hand.

At the Women's Premier League (WPL) mini auction, held at a plush hotel in the suburbs of Mumbai, five teams had only 30 slots to fill, with an available collective salary cap of ₹17.65 crore. Naturally, one expected them to adopt the 'horses for courses' formula while picking their preferred players at relatively affordable prices.

But by the end of it, it was all about two uncapped young Indian players — Kashvee Gautam and Vrinda Dinesh — who stole the

limelight by attracting bids of ₹2 crore and ₹1.3 crore from Gujarat Giants and the UP Warriorz, respectively.

Gujarat Giants, which had 10 slots to fill, came into the auction with a purse of ₹5.95 crore, and it did not hesitate in splurging big on young Indian players who had an impressive run in the domestic circuit.

Kashvee — a seam-bowling all-rounder who went unsold in the last edition — made all heads turn. Having represented India A in the recent T20 series against England A, Kashvee impressed with her bowling performances, delivering breakthroughs in crunch moments.

Her 12 wickets at the Senior Women's T20 Trophy last month earned her a spot in the India A team. Prior to that, she was a part of

Money matters: Mallika Sagar, auctioneer of the WPL mini auction. It had only 30 slots to be filled by the five franchises, with an available collective salary cap of ₹17.65 crore. SPORTZPICS/BCCI